Reply to a data request: confirm receipt

A short reply that confirms a request has arrived, gives a reference and the date the answer is due, and says what happens next.

FOR
Organisations in the EU, Iceland, Liechtenstein or Norway that receive a request under Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR (the EU General Data Protection Regulation): the data protection officer, privacy team or small-business owner who answers. Notes for Italy and Germany where the rules differ.

NOT COVERED
Requests under other laws (freedom of information, medical records, personnel files), which may need a separate reply; national rules on when a message counts as received (the EDPB notes some Member States have them, footnote 90).

LAW AS OF
GDPR (Regulation (EU) 2016/679) as published on EUR-Lex, read 7 Nov 2026; EDPB Guidelines 01/2022 on the right of access, version 2.1 (adopted 28 March 2023, minor corrections 30 May 2024); Regulation (EEC, Euratom) 1182/71, Article 3; Italian Data Protection Code (Legislative Decree 196/2003) as on Normattiva (updated to the act published on 19 Feb 2026), read 4 to 8 Nov 2026; Garante complaint page (docweb 4535524), read 7 Nov 2026; BDSG as published on gesetze-im-internet.de, last amended by the Act of 12 May 2026, read 7 Nov 2026

VERSION
1.1, 8 November 2026

When to use this

Send it as soon as a request arrives. The European Data Protection Board (EDPB), the body of all EU data protection regulators, considers it *"good practice"* to confirm receipt in writing, *"confirming that their requests have been received and that the one month period runs from day X to day Y"* (EDPB Guidelines 01/2022, para. 57, p. 24). The EDPB writes this about access requests; the same one-month limit in Article 12(3) covers every right in Articles 15 to 22.

What the law requires

The answer is due *"without undue delay and in any event within one month of receipt of the request"* (Article 12(3)). For access requests the EDPB says the time limit starts *"when the request reaches the controller through one of its official channels"*, and *"It is not necessary that the controller is in fact aware of the request"* (para. 159, p. 50). A request sent through a channel the organisation provides, other than the preferred one, *"shall be, in general, considered effective"* (para. 53, p. 23).

If it is unclear which right the person wants, the EDPB recommends asking them; this *"shall not affect the duty of the controller to act without undue delay"* (para. 48, p. 21). Where the organisation holds a large quantity of information about the person, it may ask them to *"specify the information or processing activities to which the request relates"* (recital 63, one of the GDPR's introductory explanations); the EDPB says the time limit may then be suspended until they reply (para. 159, p. 50).

Do not ask for proof of identity by default: Article 12(6) allows it only with *"reasonable doubts"* (Article 12(6)). The identity reply in this set covers that case.

The letter

Fill in the parts in braces and delete the options that do not apply. Work out the due date first. For what the person asked for, write for example: give you access to your personal data, correct your data, erase your data, restrict the use of your data, send your data in a reusable format, stop using your data for a purpose, or review an automated decision.

The paragraph beginning 'We hold a large amount of information' is optional: keep it only if you hold a large quantity of data about the person (recital 63).

ORGANISATION NAME, ADDRESS,
DATA PROTECTION CONTACT OR DATA PROTECTION OFFICER

NAME OF THE PERSON, ADDRESS OR E-MAIL THEY USED

DATE

Subject: We have received your request

Your request of DATE OF THE REQUEST, received on DATE RECEIVED. Our reference: REFERENCE.

Thank you for your request. We understand that you are asking us to WHAT THE PERSON ASKED FOR under Article ARTICLE NUMBER, 15 TO 22 of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). If we have misunderstood, please tell us.

We will reply without undue delay and at the latest by DUE DATE. If the request proves complex, or we receive many requests, we may need up to two further months; if so, we will tell you before DUE DATE and explain why (Article 12(3) GDPR).

We hold a large amount of information about you, for example in SYSTEMS OR SERVICES. Could you tell us whether your request concerns particular information or activities, such as a period or a service? If you would rather not, we will answer for all the data we hold.

This request is free of charge. NAME OR TEAM is handling it. You can reach us at CONTACT, AND OUR DATA PROTECTION OFFICER AT ....

Kind regards,

NAME AND ROLE OF THE PERSON SIGNING, for ORGANISATION NAME

Check before you send

Count the due date with Fino's Response timeline: one month from the day the request arrived, moved to the next working day if it falls on a weekend or public holiday (EDPB, paras 160 to 161, pp. 50 to 51). Enter the request in the register (see the procedure in this set). If the person wrote by e-mail, answer by e-mail where possible, unless they ask otherwise (Article 12(3)). The tool does not know public holidays: check the due day yourself.

How the organisation handles it: Handling data requests: procedure and register. Its replies: confirm receipt, confirm identity, extend the time limit, refuse or charge a fee, the answer.

The letters from the person: access, rectification, erasure, restriction, portability, objection, automated decisions.

Sources

GDPR, Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (EUR-Lex) • Used for: Articles 12, 15 to 22, 37, 38, 77 and 79, recitals; Fino's copy of each article is linked in the text

EDPB Guidelines 01/2022 on data subject rights: right of access, version 2.1 • Used for: How regulators read the right of access, time limits and identity checks (paragraphs and pages cited)

Regulation (EEC, Euratom) 1182/71 on periods, dates and time limits (EUR-Lex) • Used for: How a period in months is counted

Fino: Response timeline • Used for: Counting the one-month deadline